

FURTHER EXAMPLES

He **had cooked** dinner before Sally **got back** from work.



She **had** already **read** the play by the time she **went** to see it.



The traffic **was** bad because a car **had broken down** on the road.



When we **arrived** at the stadium, the game **had** already **started**.



Even if the past simple action is first in the sentence, it still happened later.

13.2 THE PRESENT PERFECT AND PAST PERFECT

PRESENT PERFECT SIMPLE

The present perfect is used to talk about an action that took place in the recent past and is still relevant to the present moment.



ONE HOUR AGO



NOW

I'm so excited.
I have just passed
my driving test.

PAST PERFECT SIMPLE

The past perfect is used to talk about an action that took place before another moment in the past.



ONE HOUR BEFORE



PAST



NOW

I was so excited.
I had just passed
my driving test.